on the Atlantic cod fishery; no further cod could be harvested from the ocean. His ruling was a necessity; the volume of northern cod was down to 1 percent of previous levels. The region had been overfished to the point where recovery could not occur if fishing were allowed to continue. Crosbie called it the toughest political moment of his career. The decision put thousands of Canadians out of jobs. For 500 years, the cod fishery had supported Maritime residents, particularly in Newfoundland.

The 1992 moratorium was initially supposed to last only two years, but, with the stocks not yet recovered, it did not end until 2024. From around 2005 to 2015, the volume of northern cod rose by about 30 percent each year along Newfoundland's northeast coast, although stocks further south did not recover as fast. In 2017 and 2018, however, cod numbers declined sharply, and the overall stocks were still too low to support large-scale fishing. Climate change contributed to the problem: higher temperatures created conditions in which both the cod and its food sources struggle to survive. A further blow to Newfoundland's fishermen—who largely turned to catching shrimp and crab—is that where cod numbers improved, cod began eating the shrimp. Now that the moratorium is over, scientists are watching stocks closely to see what the impact will be.